

Re: Subject: Re: Cory Shepherd (388372)

— urgent food and payment today

From: Matthew Beetham from Together

Queensland representation@together.org.au

To: coryshepherd1@hotmail.com

coryshepherd1@hotmail.com

Sent: Thursday 3 September at 14:52

Hi Cory,

Thank you for your email, and I am sorry to hear about your situation.

We wanted to let you know about a service called the Workers' Psychological Support Service (WPSS), which is available to Together members. It is set up to assist workers with work-related physical or mental health issues or injuries (including a lack of support from management).

We would recommend giving them a call or sending a message via <https://wpss.org.au/> or [1800 370 732](tel:1800370732).

They provide connections to a wide range of services including mental health support, work safety issues, and financial counselling.

We have had very positive feedback from other members who have used them, but it is completely your choice as to whether you are interested in speaking with them.

Take care,

Matthew Beetham

Member Assist
Together ASU



Ph: [1800 177 244](tel:1800177244)

E: representation@together.org.au

Visit the [Member Only Portal](#) for instant access to a wealth of information on your rights at work, as well as a growing library of Frequently Asked Questions.

Together recognises and respects the Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples of the lands upon which we undertake our work to promote and defend the interests and values of members. We acknowledge the Traditional Owners and custodians who have cared for this country for thousands of years.

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On Thursday, 3 September 2026, 2:15:39 pm

+1000, Cory Shepherd

<coryshepherd1@hotmail.com> wrote:

Hi Emily,

Thank you for letting me know.

I understand you need time to review the material and I am not asking you to answer the substantive matters today.

I do need to make clear that I have not eaten properly in days and I have no funds available for food. I am asking only whether you can make a call today to Payroll, Jacqui, or the appropriate contact to see whether the ad hoc payment can be actioned urgently, or tell me who I should contact directly.

If you have any member welfare, hardship, or emergency-support option available through Together, could you please let me know today.

I am available on [0417 400 227](tel:0417400227) at any time.

Thank you,
Cory

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From: Emily Petering from Together Queensland

<representation@together.org.au>

Sent: Thursday, September 3, 2026 2:10:44 pm

To: Cory Shepherd

<coryshepherd1@hotmail.com>

Subject: Re: Cory Shepherd (388372) —

application for long service leave and annual leave,
and request for AVAC to be processed today

Hi Cory

I was out of the office yesterday (Wednesday)
and in meetings with members this morning.

I am currently reviewing the 14 emails I've
received on your matter this week. My plan is to
review them as I am able over the next few days
and reply to you with answers to your specific
questions in the below by the end of the week.

Kind regards

Emily Petering

Member Assist
Together ASU

Ph: 1800 177 244

E: representation@together.org.au



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On Wednesday, 2 September 2026,
12:14:39 pm +1000, Cory Shepherd

<coryshepherd1@hotmail.com> wrote:

Hi Emily and Heath,

I need the union to act on this now, and I would like to speak with you by phone today if you can manage it.

Where I am

I have received no wages since 13 July 2026 over fifty-one days, three pay runs. I have lost my accommodation. I am certified fit with restrictions on Metro South's own form and have been ready and available since 3 July, and no instrument for keeping me out has ever been identified despite my asking on 4 August. I cannot log into MyHR, so I cannot even see what has been applied to my record.

You were copied on Monday's exchange with Chloe, so you saw it: my formal application produced the first payment action in 59 days — but for one fortnight only, at "0.5 FTE" on an arrangement that expired on 28 June, with sick leave in the mix, and with long service leave blocked "by the system". I corrected all of that within 32 minutes. Nothing has come back since Monday afternoon; not on the payment, not on the coding, not on long service leave, and not from Payroll on anything. I have today asked for an ad hoc payment to be processed immediately.

The attached two-page brief has the whole record: every request since 3 July, the key passages verbatim with timestamps, and what I am asking for.

What I am asking the union to do

1. Start a wages claim. I have been ready, willing and able within the certified restrictions since 3 July. This does not depend on the medical process and I do not want it to wait behind it any longer.

2. Get the ad hoc payment moving. The entitlement is already approved under PRN 249 863 66. An approved entitlement, unpaid, with a member who has lost his housing, is something I hope the union can move with a phone call where my emails have not.

3. Fix the coding and the rate. Sick leave removed and replaced in accordance with my application; leave applied at my substantive 76 hours, not "0.5 FTE"; and the full period from 13 July adjusted, not one fortnight. If MSH defends the 0.5 FTE, then they are paying my leave on a roster they refuse to roster me to and I would like the union to put that to them.

4. Long service leave. The system "will not allow" it. I commenced on 25 March 2019 and my February 2025 reinstatement preserved continuity, so seven years fell due on 25 March 2026. If Payroll's service date says otherwise, it was never corrected after reinstatement and has been wrong for eighteen months.

5. A decision. That MSH either return me to work within the 3 July restrictions by a stated date, or give me a written decision declining to, identifying the instrument and the officer. I would rather have a decision I can respond to than continue with none.

6. A referral to Hall Payne, for advice on a personal injury matter arising from my employment. I understand a member referral carries more weight than a cold

approach, and I would be grateful if you could make the introduction this week.

I want to be straightforward with you: this is causing me severe distress and I am not coping with it financially or otherwise.

Could you call me on [0417 400 227](tel:0417400227) today?
Any time.

Thank you, Emily.

Cory Shepherd

[0417 400 227](tel:0417400227)

coryshepherd1@hotmail.com

From: Emily Petering

<Emily.Petering@together.org.au>

Sent: Wednesday, September 2, 2026

11:07:56 am

To: Cory Shepherd

<coryshepherd1@hotmail.com>

Subject: Automatic reply: Cory Shepherd
(388372) — application for long service leave
and annual leave, and request for AVAC to be
processed today

Thank you for your email. I'm currently out of
the office, returning Thursday 3 September.

If your matter is urgent, please contact
assistance@together.org.au Otherwise, I will
respond when I'm back.

Kind regards

Emily

